Bayonet, carried in scabbard attached to loop hanging from belt

WIRE CUTTERS

Tools
The infantryman spent very little time actually fighting. His normal daily tasks were more likely to be digging and repairing trenches, filling sandbags, and checking the barbed wire along his unit's stretch of the front.

ENTRENCHING TOOL HANDLE

CLASP KNIFE

ENTRENCHING TOOL

MESS TIN

CANTEEN

Buckle to attach bottle to webbing

MUG

Food and water
Every man in the trenches was issued with a canteen, a mug, and a mess tin. Rations, like other supplies for the front line, were normally brought up under cover of darkness.



Putting on puttees

BOOTS

PUTTEE

Boots and puttees
The boots of 1914 were of a prewar brown pattern but most boots issued subsequently were black. Puttees (from a Hindi word) were long strips of cloth wound round the calf to give support and protection to the leg.

"SOME OF THE FELLOWS HAD PUTTEES WRAPPED ROUND THEIR FEET INSTEAD OF BOOTS; OTHERS HAD SOFT SHOES THEY HAD PICKED UP SOMEWHERE; OTHERS WALKED IN THEIR SOCKS, WITH THEIR FEET ALL BLEEDING."

CORPORAL BERNARD JOHN DENORE DESCRIBING BRITISH RETREAT FROM MONS, AUGUST 1914